

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 720 August 2009 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON

A promotional poster for a speaking tour. The background is a photograph of a person in a blue and red jacket and red boots standing on a rocky outcrop in a snowy, mountainous landscape. The text is overlaid on the right side of the image.

STEPHEN VENABLES

HIMALAYAN CLIMBING LEGEND
FOR THE FIRST TIME IN NEW ZEALAND
NATIONAL SPEAKING TOUR
AUGUST 31 - SEPTEMBER 4 2009

 **NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB**

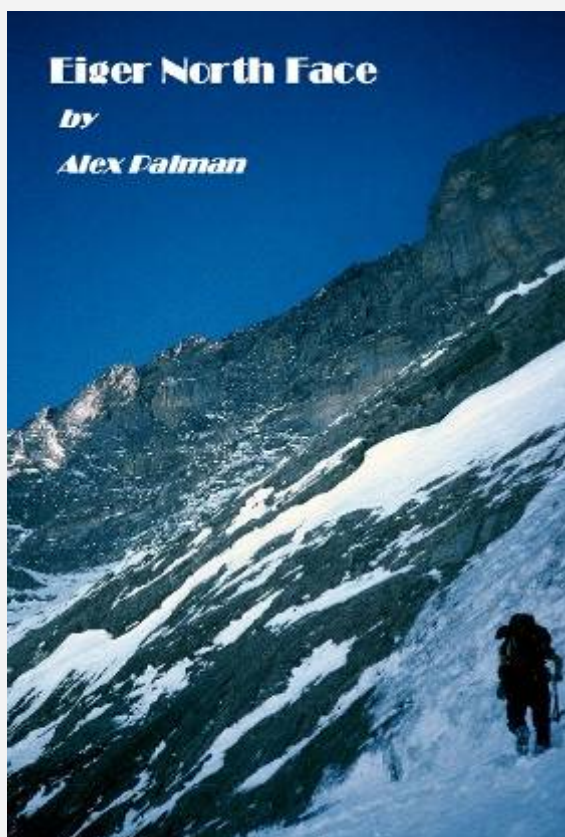
Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 3 August 2009

Eiger North Face – Alex Palman

Alex palman presents a slideshow of his winter ascent of this foreboding wall, via the infamous Heckmair–Harrer route.



Notice of AGM

At the 7 September club night we will first be holding the 2009 AGM for the Wellington Section. This is a most important meeting in our annual calendar and we encourage all members to attend. Of most interest will be the Election of Officers. We will be looking to replenish the committee with a fresh batch of keen bods and new ideas.

All nominations for committee positions should be sent to The Secretary at secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz or alternatively nominations will be taken from the floor. For more details of this meeting (including the agenda) please refer to the Notice of AGM 2009 at <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?p=1842>

The speaker at this meeting will be Brian McGlinchy, who was a member of the expedition to the Antarctic in 1959-60.

Stephen Venables Speaking in Wellington



It's not often a mountaineer of Stephen's calibre, both in climbing and in public speaking, visits New Zealand. Take the opportunity to hear him speak on his "Himalayan Odyssey" in Wellington on 1st September, 2009.

Venue: Lecture Theatre 101, MacLaurin Building, Kelburn Campus, Victoria University

Tickets: \$15 retail / \$12 NZAC members, available from 3 August from Bivouac Wellington, or at the August section night (email sm@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for details)

Stephen Venables, British mountaineer, author and public speaker, is one of the most successful climbers of his generation.

The first Brit to summit Everest without supplementary oxygen, he began his mountaineering career in the European Alps in the mid sixties. Keen to explore further afield, he made a pioneering expedition to the Afghan Hindu Kush in 1977, which was to set the tone for his explorative Himalayan climbing over the next three decades.

Stephen's first ascents in the Greater Ranges include extreme new routes on Kishtwar Shivling and Panchuli V (India), and Kusum Kangru (Nepal), and he has enjoyed climbing with many of the world's best exploratory mountaineers, including Chris Bonnington, Reinhold Messner and Harish Kapadia. His historic climb of Everest involved reaching the summit alone via a new route on the huge Kangshung Face, then bivouacking in the open at 8,600m and suffering frostbite on descent.

He has authored eleven books, including 'Painted Mountain' which won the Boardman Tasker Prize for Mountain Literature in 1985, and 'Himalayan Alpine Style,' considered by many climbers to be the 'bible' of bold Himalayan climbing.



SECTION TRIP NEWS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Mt Ruapehu South Girdlestone and Tahurangi, 3rd – 5th July

The weather forecast was looking a bit dire leading into the trip, but the call went out on Thursday that it was going ahead. There was hope that some climbing could be done on Saturday morning before the predicted rain front came through in the afternoon.

The group consensus was to have a bit of ‘luxury’ in the weekend and stay in a backpackers. After the last minute discovery of an accommodation mix-up the group was forced to change plans to the dreaded Alpine Lodge. Kevin, the club’s trip coordinator, had previously warned of the “scary Ohakune backpacker” with DRDs and SBCs staying there (note, you will have to ask Kevin for the definition and story to give it full justice).

After swearing at the north bound School holiday traffic it was welcome relief to stop in Bulls for a kebab. This also provided a bit of comic relief with lots of deliberate, and possibly non-deliberate, word play on the bull theme. Unbelievably, this game, regarded by some as the lowest form of humour, retained its humorous appeal for a remarkably long time. No bull.

The clear skies on the drive up helped to motivate an early start, although after dealing with multiple disruptions in the 5 hrs remaining for sleep there may have been some regrets about this decision. The day dawned with the walk up the ski field. It didn’t take long before one of the Steves decided that the lure of a day skiing was too great, and he headed back down to swap gear and enjoy the lifts.



Photo courtesy of Reece Geursen

The rest of the group headed for the top of the chair lifts where it split into two, one group gaining the skyline ridge and heading for the top of Tahurangi and the other traversing the ridge and crossing the glacier towards Girdlestone's south face.

The Tahurangi group reached the top in time to enjoy spectacular views of the Crater Lake and surrounds. Meanwhile the Girdlestone team was making progress on the south face. This group had split into pairs to pitch the top part of the face and, after losing sight of each other for most of the climb, crossed paths again with less than 100 m to go to the top. It was also at this point that we came into view of Tahurangi once again, only to see it complete shrouded in a dark menacing cloud that was heading our way. Because of the rapidly deteriorating visibility the decision was made to head down the Mangaehuehu face back to the ski field. Unbelievably the cloud never really left the top Tahurangi, and the rest of the mountain stayed clear.



Photo courtesy of Rongo Patel

The Girdlestone group was still keen for some activity and so we stopped by the frozen waterfall on the way down and set up a top rope for a play. The groups finally rejoined back in Ohakune at the pub for a meal, beer, and an early night.



Photo courtesy of Vincent Zintzen

We slept in on the Sunday with the view that the forecast had it right and we would be waking up for rain and snow. Logistics meant that one group ended up returning to Wellington early while another group decided to brave the snow and visit the waterfall ice. This ended up being more about the drudge up there, but the group persisted and all had a top rope along with a couple of other climbers that showed up. The weather wasn't very accommodating with it snowing the whole time and being bloody cold. All agreed it was worth it though.

Overall an enjoyable trip!



Photo courtesy of Reece Geursen

AIC – a photo montage by Paul Bird







UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Ruapehu North, Te Heu Heu Dome & Paretetaitonga

Date: 7 – 9 August 2009

Leader: Robert Hawes

Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter.

Contact Robert at 027 447 0461 or by email roberth@tfg.co.nz



AIC Expedition - Northern South Island

Date: 18 – 21 September 2009

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience (AIC grads first preference, all welcome)

The destination is to be set by the AIC group, as part of the planning exercise. It is a 'mystery trip'. Come and join the AIC graduates and welcome them to the world of mountaineering. This could even be a good chance to discover a new climbing buddy!

Contact Don French, ph 06 377 7117 (h) or by email df@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Arapiles, Victoria, Australia

Date: 22 – 27 October 2009

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 1 - 33, 4000+ routes, most multi-pitch, 99% trad climbing

The Arapiles is a legendary area for rock climbing in Australia. All trad, with a huge number and range of routes, there will be something for everyone on this trip. From three starred multipitch grade 5 climbs (yes, grade 5), through to bonkers grade 30+ routes with minimal pro, the Arapiles has it all. If you're interested in finding out more about the Arapiles area check the following website: www.chockstone.org



The plan is to fly over on Thursday to Melbourne, pickup a cheap rental and drive (4h) to the Arapiles for 4-5 days (Fri-Tues) of trad climbing on the best rock in the planet. Climb classics like Muldoon and The Bard. Flying back to Wellington on Tuesday afternoon/evening. Do NOT miss this opportunity to climb on solid, red, metamorphised sandstone.

Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or by email kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Centennial

Date: 20 – 29 November 2009

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

Trip involves travelling to Franz Josef and then choppering into Centennial Hut for a week of climbing. There are a number of alpine climbing options including The Minarets, De La Beche. For those who like cross-country skiing the Centennial – Pioneer Huts traverse is a must! If you want to try some quality rock the pioneer Range is not far away, and there are multi-pitch classics such as Moonshine Butress (crux 17) nearby as well. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Centennial Hut on the Franz Josef neve



Annual NZAC Climbing Camp, Matukituki Valley

Date: 2 – 9 January 2010

This years Climbing Camp will be in the Matukituki Valley adjacent to Aspiring Hut, from Saturday 2nd January to Saturday 9th January 2010. It will be hosted by the Otago Section and is a fantastic opportunity for climbers and their families to gather in the mountains for climbing, tramping and generally have fun. There is some fantastic climbing in the area; from the easy peaks of Tyndal and Ansted above Cascade saddle to the many climbs accessible from Colin Todd and French Ridge huts, including Mt Aspiring, Mt French and Mt Avalanche.

See NZAC website for details <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/377>). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for carpooling arrangements.



Paynes Ford / Pohara

Date: 22 – 25 January 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 15-30

Come spend the long anniversary weekend in 'hippie-ville'. Golden Bay hosts two of the finest limestone crags with long mid-range routes at Pohara and hard classics at Paynes Ford. There is something here for everyone including beaches with white hot sand at Pohara and extensive cool swimming holes adjacent to the Hang Dog campground at Paynes. Relax afterwards with a meal of Mussels and Guinness while watching the cricket at the Pohara Pub. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Nikki on the Pohara cliffs

OBITUARY: Connan, I remember you, by Tony Gates

Screentime Productions recently presented their TV show “The Missing”, with a feature on former NZAC member Connan Bolitho. It was a moving tribute to a keen mountain man, with his parents, sister, friends, SAR personnel, and tramping companions Mike Peat, Pauler Carryer, and Derek Bilby speaking. Some readers may recall the tall blonde man and his great love of the mountains. Connan, I remember you as an enthusiastic mountaineer of great ability, strength, and fitness, and an excellent companion in the mountains.

I first met Connan on Mt Ruapehu during 1988. We practised some alpine travel in preparation for a Garden of Eden traverse. He was still in his teens, but impressed me with his experience, knowledge, and understanding of equipment. We checked our fitness in the Tararuas and Ruahines, and once had a crazy race through Orongorongo scrub and swamp that could have only one winner. We climbed in the Canterbury alps, gaining the summits of Outram and Sword, and gazing longingly at others, including D’ Árchiac. Connan did a few other trips into that area, so planned one day to tramp and climb from Arthurs Pass- Mt Cook. He honed his skills on Mt Ruapehu, the Tararuas, and the Southern Alps, and I enjoyed several great trips with him over a couple of years. February 1991, we climbed Mt Arrowsmith, and admired much of his planned route. Connan set off on a solo Arthurs Pass - Mt Cook Village, during Easter 1991, then disappeared. This was the first of several heavy snow years. The initial Search concentrated on the West Coast side - an area with many DoC huts, tracks, and bridges. In conjunction with “The Missing” TV programme, the 2009 Search continued here, but also looked at possible routes that he could have followed on the eastern side of the divide. 2009 SAR techniques and equipment offered some useful ideas. Connan’s father suggested that the most suitable memorial to his son was the mountains where we believe he now lies.

Connan, unique and strong, I remember you.



Pete Barnes, Tony Gates, Connan Bolitho,
on the summit of Mt Arrowsmith, February 1991.



NOTICES



Avalanche awareness courses

Turoa and Whakapapa ski patrols, in conjunction with the NZ Mountain safety council, are offering a series of avalanche awareness courses to be held over the following dates:

<u>Date</u>	<u>Location</u>
28/29 July	Whakapapa
5/6 August	Turoa
27/28 August	Whakapapa
10/11 September	Turoa
17/18 September	Whakapapa

The Avalanche Awareness course involves both a lecture and a field day, and covers:

- Mountain weather
- Identification of avalanche terrain
- Basic route finding and decision making
- Companion rescue
- Safety equipment (including use of transceivers)

The awareness course is a prerequisite to the Backcountry Avalanche course offered later in the year. For more information visit <http://tinyurl.com/mkbraf>



Rock Climbing Guidebooks

A range of rock climbing guidebooks are now available for download on the NZAC website: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product?filter0=59> Currently available guidebooks include:

- Mangaraho, Tokatoka and Ti Point – Northland
- Sawyers Crag – Mt Cook
- Mt Maunganui – Tauranga

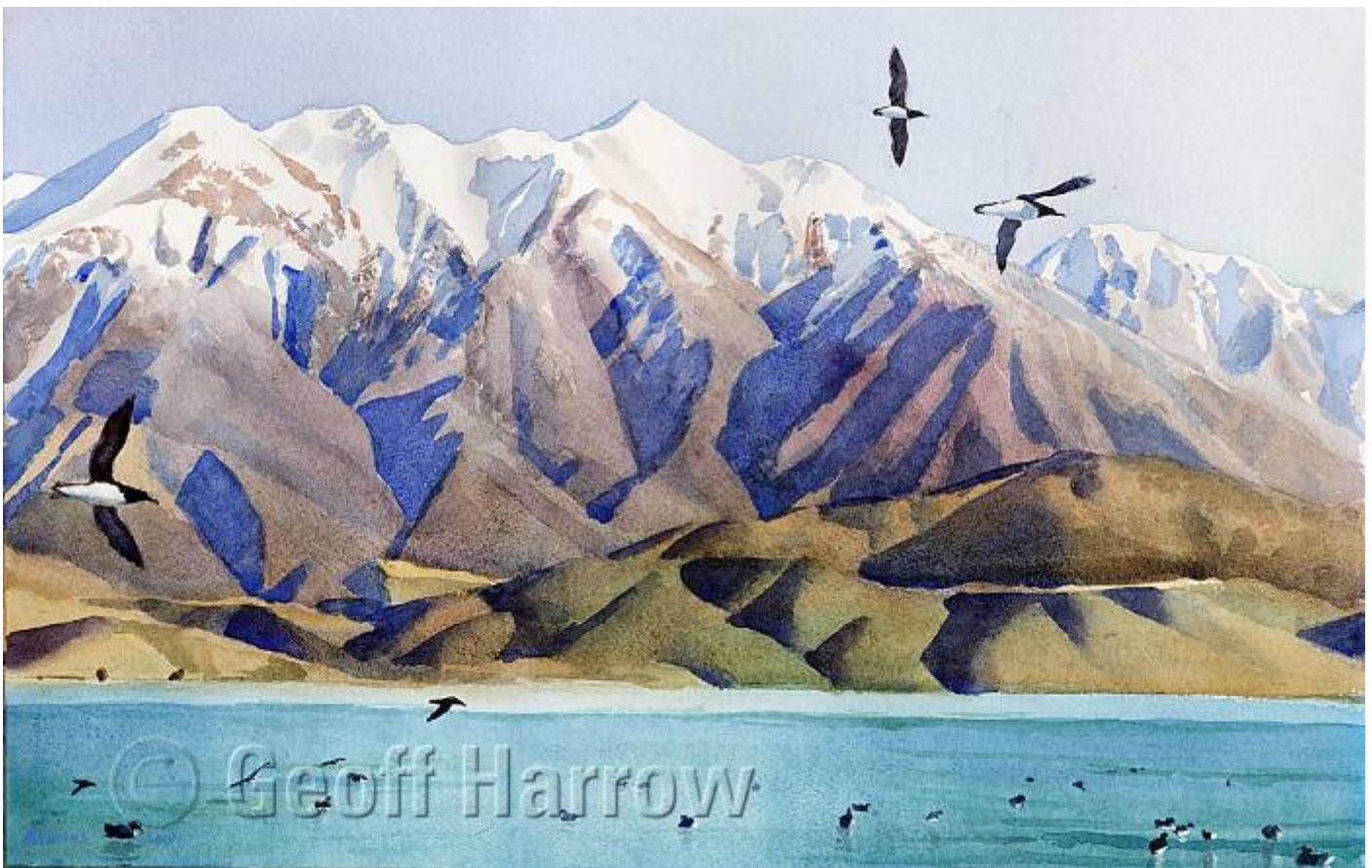
While downloads are free, we are asking people to consider making a donation to assist in covering any associated costs. The old Northern Rock guidebook is being revised and uploaded in sections first and will be followed by Auckland (Mt Eden) Quarry.



Support The Endangered Hutton's Shearwater

Have you ever dreamed of owning a mountain landscape by the renowned alpine painter Austen Deans?

Austen's paintings usually sell for many thousands of dollars. Recently Austen completed a painting of the snow covered Seaward Kaikoura Range with the endangered Hutton's Shearwaters in the foreground, commissioned by Geoff Harrow, founder / settler of The Hutton's Shearwater Charitable Trust. Austen has signed fifty numbered prints which are for sale at \$250.00 each and all proceeds go to this trust for predator fencing, research and monitoring.



If you would like to purchase one of these prints, you can contact Geoff Harrow at 9 Alderson Ave, Christchurch 8022, phone 03 332 4534 or by emailing Lindsay Rowe at lindsay.jan.rowe@xtra.co.nz



Summer Work on the Glacier, October 2009 to April 2010

The best climbing, tramping and kayaking in New Zealand could be right outside your back door. Live and work in this unique environment - where glaciers, rainforest and the ocean meet. You'll be guiding visitors from New Zealand and all over the world on the Fox Glacier.

Work with one of New Zealand's most established and highly regarded adventure tourism operators. A caring and progressive company, you'll have access to ongoing professional training with the New Zealand Mountain Guides Association.

You'll need to have an outdoor background, be physically fit, outgoing, enthusiastic and be able to bring the area alive for your clients. You'll also need a relevant work visa, have a full drivers license - a Class 2 with a Passenger Endorsement is an advantage. Your initial contract would start October 2009 - end April 2010. Ongoing positions may become available.

Download application forms at www.foxguides.co.nz For a guiding application form contact tamrab@foxguides.co.nz



Fox Glacier Guiding, PO Box 38, Fox Glacier. Phone (03) 751 0825 ext 7.



Photo Competition Awards

Thanks to artist Corey Koppe the Egmont-Tasman Trophy for the inter-section Photocomp award has been restored. It will now remain on display, alongside the John Harrison Memorial Trophy (painting), in the Clubs Reference Library.

As the Dorflinger and Guide Alack Trophies are still missing, this notice to see whether there may be an individual, or company that would be interested in donating replacement trophies for these two awards. Trophies don't have to be in the form of a cup, the Dorflinger Trophy was, in fact, a wooden carving of a flower, so options can be discussed. The two missing categories are for the most outstanding alpine nature photograph and the most outstanding mountaineering photograph (as judged by a mountaineer). A donation could mean providing the award itself, or possibly the commissioning of an award as was the case with the John Harrison painting.

Expressions of interest can be made to the National Office, please contact Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz

STEPHEN VENABLES

'Himalayan Odyssey' Tour



Bold Adventures in the World's Greater Ranges

- Internationally acclaimed mountaineer, author and speaker
- First Brit to climb Everest without oxygen
- Award Winning Author — Recipient of the Boardman Tasker Prize for Mountain Literature and the Banff International Mountain Festival Grand Prize and Best Book awards.

Brought to you by the New Zealand Alpine Club



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB



Wellington

Tuesday 1 September, 7.30pm,
101, MacLaurin Building, Victoria University Kelburn Campus.

NZAC Members \$12, Non-members \$15

Tickets available from Bivouac Wellington or by contacting Steve at sm@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



ROCK CLIMBING



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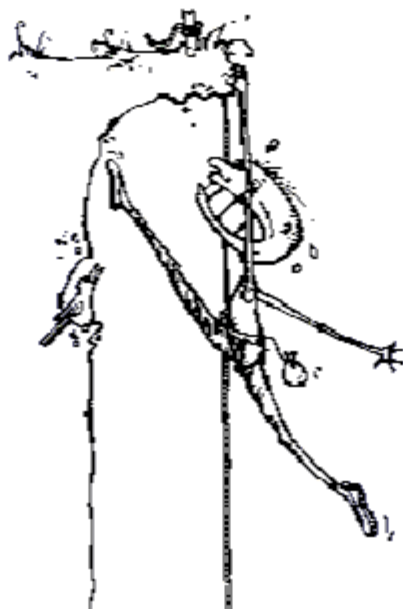
Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.

Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2009/10 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Gwen Rashbrooke	vicechair or GR	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	973 1307 (h) (021) 079 0854
Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	(027) 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Scott Taylor	ST	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	934 0975 (h) (027) 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Louise Thornley	LT	
	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	Shichang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Max Gough	MG	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Blair Hiscoke	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	(06) 3777 117 (h) (027) 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	(03) 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

